

AELITA

PRODUCTION

PRESS RELEASE

Stary Oskol, August 19, 2026

AELITA PRODUCTION Launches the “Tochka Cuire” Contemporary Art Festival in Stary Oskol

From October 22 to 25, 2026, CSI “Byl” (Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38) hosts the first edition of the “Tochka Cuire” contemporary art festival — fifteen productions over four days: from the flagship mystery play to physical theatre, performances and a promenade show, plus exhibitions, a business programme, a lecture series and a children’s programme. Ticket sales for the opening production, “IOV: Material”, are already open; sales for the other shows open later. All other festival events are free.

TOCHKA CUIRE — THE POINT AT WHICH MATTER CHANGES STATE

~770°C — the temperature at which metal loses and regains its magnetic properties. Discovered by Pierre Curie in 1895.

The name speaks directly to the city’s identity: Stary Oskol sits on the Kursk Magnetic Anomaly, the world’s largest deposit of magnetic iron ore. A Curie point is the moment at which matter changes state. The festival does the same: art as a point after which a state changes — the audience, the space and the city do not return to what they were.

PROGRAMME

The flagship production is AELITA PRODUCTION’s contemporary mystery play “IOV: Material”, the festival’s opening show. It is followed by guest productions from Saint Petersburg dance space OMYT (“Mayday”, “The Rashomon Effect”, “The Scent of Rose Oil”) and a site-specific performance by company OMYT (“Prophecies of Migratory Birds”), Dmitry Turkov’s interactive solo show “Do You Have a Brain?”, and AELITA PRODUCTION’s meditative detective solo piece “Porfiry”.

The festival’s business programme is an open lecture series for people who make culture and products: Mikhail Kazmiruk, curator of “New Dance” at the New Stage of the Alexandrinsky Theatre, gives a lecture on dance in the real world; journalist Alyona Bychkova gives a lecture on voice as an instrument of trust; and Alexey Tsymlov, CEO of IT company Sintropik, talks about what artificial intelligence can already do and where it gets things wrong.

A separate children’s programme features the interactive art quest “Kids Aren’t Spectators”, in which young participants become co-authors of the art objects. The exhibition programme includes “TOCHKA CUIRE. Prologue” (opening early, from October 8) and “Point of Origin: an Archaeology of the Self” (vernissage October 22). Both run through November 4; free admission.

The festival programme continues to grow — check the festival website for the current line-up and schedule.

ABOUT THE VENUE

CSI “Byl” is the first contemporary art centre in the Belgorod region, opened in 2023 in the restored building of the former “Byl” cinema (1982). Two auditoriums — Blue Hall (496 seats) and Red Hall (168 seats) — allow parallel performances.

ABOUT THE COMPANY

AELITA PRODUCTION is a theatre production company founded in 2025 by Ekaterina Abdulova and Konstantin Moshnikov. Over the company's history — more than 10 projects delivered and a presence in 4 Russian cities. The company produces the creation, touring and distribution of productions at the intersection of contemporary theatre, choreography and visual art.

DATE AND PLACE

October 22–25, 2026

CSI “Byl”, Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38

Tickets and festival programme: <https://aelita-production.ru/en/tochkacuire>

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